

What will T20 cricket look like in 2020?



Former Australian coach John Buchanan, with whom the team won two World Championships and a Champions Trophy title, sees T20 becoming a third arm of the game, one that will sharpen cricket skills

Cricket, Buchanan maintains, must retain its ability to appeal to the masses and have room for a variety of physical sizes. The challenge for the game is to see if the limited-over forms of the game—both 50-over and 20—can do so, as there is a chance Twenty20 could turn into a game meant only for big muscle-loaded batsmen who can clear the field and bowlers who can bowl a heavy ball. While Test cricket must remain supreme, "its difficulty will be resisting all the hype from the other forms of the game". Test cricket must be pitched as the "God", and other limited-over forms as those that serve it.

Fielding and Wicketkeeping

Players' abilities will have to improve to cope with power hitting and there will be little room for the unathletic, slow mover who cannot cover territory inside the ring or out. The ball will be travelling very fast, over small grounds, and stopping boundaries is a key defensive method. Reaction time, anticipation and visual acuity will all be significantly tested.

Batting

Rules and Regulations

By 2020, the administrators will have shaped the course of the game by answering a few questions. To make the game more even for both bowlers, some ideas must be contemplated, such as a standard boundary size, relaxing the field restrictions and even allowing teams to choose from 15 players in the dugout and not just the 11 on the team sheet.

The 2020 batsman will play without fear, unafraid to challenge bowlers from the first ball, prepared to go for the power hit in the air, more aware of who can field and who can't, who has a strong arm and who doesn't and pushing fielders by running on their throw or their speed to the ball. There will be more batsmen like Adam Gilchrist, Yuvraj Singh, Kevin Pietersen and Herschelle Gibbs who mix conventional shots with the unconventional, capable of putting the same ball in three or four directions. They will need speed between the wickets, because when they cannot hit boundaries, they must convert bat on ball into runs.

